

Romain Sickenberg

Backend-Software Engineer

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Backend Software Engineer with **5+ years** building and maintaining business-critical web applications and **REST APIs** with **PHP**, **Symfony**, **Laravel**, **React** and **Docker**.

Hands-on across application design, component integration and deployment (**CI/CD**), including code review, production releases and technical leadership of medium-sized projects.

Work authorization: Swiss Citizen. Available now.

Experience

Full-Stack Software Developer

03.2024 - 12.2025

Academic Work SA

IT Consulting for diverse clients via Academic Work.

- Designed a decoupled backend/frontend architecture for SIL Lausanne, delivering the **Docker** base platform that now underpins most of their in-house solutions (**Python**, **Django**, **Vue**, **React**).
 - Shipped a **React (Next.js)** application with **GitHub Actions CI/CD**, **Docker** containerization and automated deployments to Jelastic.
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Backend Software Engineer

10.2021 - 02.2023

Antistatique SA

From Junior to mid-level Software Engineer & highest skill jump!

- Built and maintained enterprise **Symfony 6** applications and their **REST APIs (API Platform)**, on **PHP 7.4/8.0** with **Doctrine ORM**, **PostgreSQL**, **Redis** caching and **Elasticsearch** indexing.
 - Led a five-developer team as **PHP Lead Developer** on a 3-4 month **Symfony** build for Colis du Coeur, shipping v1 of a state-machine-driven workflow for volunteer distribution centres.
 - Delivered and maintained six CMS builds - five **Drupal**, one **WordPress**.
 - Cut **GitHub Actions** execution time by **75%** through dependency caching and workflow optimization.
 - Owned technical delivery and led code reviews across small to medium-sized projects, including an **AWS**-hosted client platform, raising maintainability and development standards for the team.
 - Built a small internal tool on a **serverless Firebase** backend with a **Vue.js** front end.
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Junior Backend Software Engineer

02.2021 - 10.2021

Ilem Group

IT Consulting to an external client named Berdoz Vision & Audition.

- Secured and migrated a business-critical ERP serving **20 retail stores** to a newer **PHP** version, then co-built its **Laravel** replacement.
 - Configured a fleet of **44 iPads** and set up CI servers running **Codeception** and **Cypress** test suites.
 - Hardened security and developed critical components of the in-house CRM used across that same 20-store network.
 - Automated testing, monitoring and deployment with internal tooling, adding **Sentry** for error tracking.
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Apprentice Software Engineer

06.2016 - 06.2020

Liip AG

- Developed and extended internal web applications in **PHP** and **JavaScript**.
- Shipped features in an **Agile** team with **Git** and **Scrum**.
- Also trained in **C#** and **Java** as part of the apprenticeship's broader software engineering curriculum.

Personal Breaks & Side Activities

- Security agent at Securitas AG - part-time, event sector 07.2023 - 03.2024
- Planned career break - solo world travel and personal development 02.2023 - 06.2023
- Swiss Armed Forces - mandatory military service 07.2020 - 11.2020

Skills

Backend

PHP, Symfony, Laravel, Python, REST APIs, Node.js, C#, Java

Databases

PostgreSQL, MySQL, MariaDB, Prisma, Supabase, Redis, Elasticsearch

Cloud & DevOps

Docker, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Linux, Apache, Nginx, AWS, Firebase, Serverless, Google Cloud Platform (GCP)

Tools

Git, GitLab, Composer, Jira, Confluence, Scrum, Sentry, Bash

Frontend

TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Vue.js, Next.js, Nuxt.js, NPM, Bun, HTML5, CSS, Sass, Tailwind CSS, Alpine.js

Mobile

Swift 5, iOS, WatchOS, Combine, Intents, Swift UI

Education

Swiss Confederation | EPSIC @ Lausanne & CFPT @ Geneva

08.2016 - 07.2020

Federal VET Diploma in Information Technology (CFC)

RELEVANT COURSEWORK

Data modeling, Object-oriented programming principles, Data structures and algorithms, SQL databases, Database integration into web applications, Application security

Projects

Tesla Companion

01.2018 - 01.2023

Paid **iOS** & **WatchOS** App to work around Tesla cars.

- Built and published a commercial **iOS** and **watchOS** application integrating **Tesla APIs** reaching over **1,000 daily active users** and ranking **#5** in the App Store Trips category.

Fort-To-Nite

01.2017 - 01.2019

Free **iOS** wiki around Fortnite with live in-game shop indications and **Django** back-end.

- Fortnite companion app with **100,000+ downloads**, **4.6/5.0★ rating (340+ reviews)** and a peak ranking of **#19** in the App Store Reference category.

Awards

EPFL Hackathon AR/VR Game Experiences

12.2019 - 12.2019

AR/VR Hackathon

Built a "digital museum" in Virtual reality. Won the **first place** in VR experiences, built with **SteamVR** and **Unity**.

Languages

French: Native (C2) · **English:** Fluent (C2) · **German:** Intermediate (B1)